

ASCENT – Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Version 1.0 MVP | OpenAI Build Week

1. Executive Summary

Ascent is an AI-powered Opportunity Discovery and Application Agent that helps students, graduates, and young professionals discover, evaluate, prepare for, and track opportunities such as scholarships, internships, grants, fellowships, jobs, competitions, and hackathons.

2. Vision & Mission

Vision: No talented individual should miss a life-changing opportunity because they could not find it, understand it, or apply on time. Mission: Build the world's most intelligent opportunity companion.

3. Problem Statement

Opportunities are fragmented across multiple websites, difficult to evaluate, and hard to track. Users often miss deadlines or fail to submit competitive applications.

4. Scope

In Scope: Authentication, Profile Builder, Opportunity Discovery, AI Matching, AI Summaries, Application Tracker, Deadline Reminders, Application Assistant. Out of Scope: Social networking, direct application submission, recruitment marketplace, video interviews.

5. Personas

University Students, Recent Graduates, Young Founders.

6. Information Architecture

Pages: Landing, Login, Register, Dashboard, My Opportunities, Opportunity Details, AI Assistant, Profile, Settings.

7. Detailed Features

Profile Builder, Opportunity Discovery Engine, Match Score Engine, AI Opportunity Briefs, Application Tracker, Smart Notifications, Readiness Coach, CV/Cover Letter Assistant.

8. User Flows

User registers → completes profile → AI analyzes profile → dashboard displays opportunities → user saves opportunity → AI generates checklist → user applies → tracker monitors progress.

9. Screen Specifications

Dashboard: opportunity feed, recommendations, reminders. Opportunity Details: match score, requirements, deadline, checklist. AI Assistant: CV review, essay generation, cover letter drafting.

10. Database Schema

Users, Profiles, Opportunities, Saved Opportunities, Applications, Notifications, AI Recommendations.

11. Backend APIs

Auth APIs, Profile APIs, Opportunity APIs, Recommendation APIs, AI Assistant APIs, Notification APIs.

12. AI Architecture

OpenAI Responses API powers profile analysis, opportunity matching, summaries, readiness scoring, and application assistance.

13. System Architecture

Frontend: Next.js + Tailwind. Backend: Node.js/Express. Database: PostgreSQL. AI Layer: OpenAI API. Deployment: Vercel + Supabase/Postgres.

14. Success Metrics

Profile completion, opportunities saved, applications started, user retention, recommendation accuracy.

15. Hackathon Demo Script

Create a student profile, generate recommendations, show match score, generate application materials, track opportunity pipeline.

16. Team Allocation

Frontend Lead, Backend Lead, AI/Prompt Engineer, UI/UX Designer, Product & Pitch Lead.

17. Development Roadmap

Day 1: Design & Architecture. Day 2: Auth/Profile. Day 3: Discovery & Matching. Day 4: AI Assistant. Day 5: Testing. Day 6: Demo & Pitch.

18. Future Roadmap

Organization portal, auto-tracking emails, mobile app, mentor matching, learning recommendations.